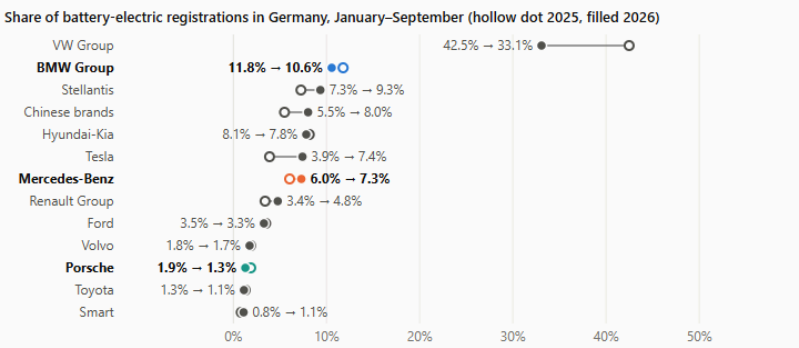
Who captured Germany's 2026 electric-car boom?

Joshua Musick, ESCP Business School · 9 October 2026 · built with an AI coding assistant

Germany's electric-car market grew 58% in January–September 2026, but VW Group's share fell from 42.5% to 33.1% as Tesla, Chinese brands and Stellantis took share. Of the German premium makers, only Mercedes-Benz gained; BMW Group and Porsche lost.



FOUR FINDINGS

1. VW Group grew, but far slower than the market. It registered 37,462 more electric cars than a year earlier, 23% more, while the market grew 58%; had it grown as fast as the market, its share would have held. The result holds after removing cars that makers and their dealers registered themselves, and each named change is larger than month-to-month noise.

2. Mercedes-Benz gained with two new models. Its share rose 1.3 points. The CLA and the electric GLC added 24,001 electric cars, more than the brand's whole increase, while its older electric models fell. BMW Group lost 1.2 points and Porsche 0.6.

3. The lift after the bonus was fully electric. After the bonus opened on 19 May, battery-electric registrations grew 43 percentage points faster than before, measured against diesel as a control; plug-in hybrids, which the bonus also covers, barely moved (+1.5). The timing fits the bonus; it does not prove it.

4. Who gained most depends on one classification. Leapmotor is a Chinese brand, but Stellantis controls its European sales through a joint venture. Counted as Chinese, the Chinese brands gained 2.5 points; counted under Stellantis, Stellantis gained 3.6 points and becomes the largest gainer, and the Chinese brands gained 1.0.

Definitions: KBA registrations, January to September of each year. "Electric" means battery-electric; a "share" is a group's part of all German electric registrations; "Chinese brands" are brands of carmakers headquartered in China (list in the README).

WHAT IT COSTS THE PREMIUM MAKERS

Porsche ties €2.4 billion of 2025 charges to its electric programme, 6.6% of its group revenue; Mercedes-Benz booked €380 million of impairment losses on vehicles with electric drives in 2024. These are the latest years each company itemised. BMW does not itemise electric charges.

WHAT WOULD CHANGE THE CONCLUSION

- **VW Group wins share back** if its October–December 2026 share is above its October–December 2025 share of 39.4% (KBA, January 2027).
- **The challengers' gain reverses** if the Chinese brands' share in that quarter falls below their 6.3% of a year earlier.

SOURCES

KBA registration tables, BAFA, the EU Official Journal, company reports and releases; every source with its date, and the limits of the analysis, are in SOURCES.md and README.md. Not investment advice.